

10

biggest art moments

Intent has usually scored over impact in the Indian art scene. While the innovative Bharat Bhavan is in ruins, Indian artists have made global progress with several breaking the \$1-million ceiling in the global market

1 A Creative Crossroad Cholamandalam Artists Village

Way back in 1964, when artists found themselves without support, the principal, students and artists associated with the Madras School of Arts decided upon setting up an institute where artists could live as a community and pool their skills. Thus was born Cholamandalam Artists Village (CAV) with K.C.S. Paniker being one of the pioneering spirits behind it. CAV is probably one of the few artist-driven movements that India has spawned. The organisation has a permanent art gallery to hold exhibitions, shows and sales. The institute grew into one of the most important meeting places for international artists in the 1970s and after.

PANKAJ TIWARI

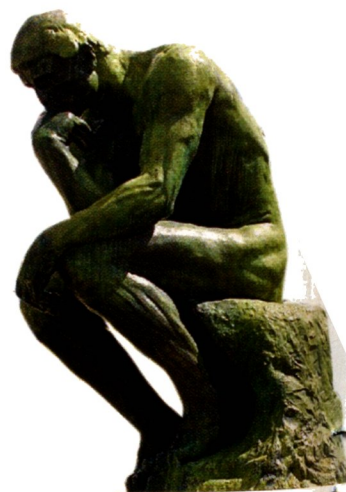


2 Cultural Spark Bharat Bhavan

"The list of participants sounded like a cultural Who's Who of India," observed INDIA TODAY in March 1982. The occasion was the opening of a Rs 1.2-crore arts complex, Bharat Bhavan, designed by Charles Correa, inaugurated by then prime minister Indira Gandhi and sponsored entirely by the Madhya Pradesh government. The organisation provided a space for contemporary expression for the first time in India. Sadly, it's now a ruin of its former self thanks to government neglect, misuse and mismanagement.

3 Majestic Arrival Rodin Comes to India

In what is called the most definitive show in the art history of Modern India, French Avant Garde: 1880-1930 was brought to India in collaboration with the French Government, under the directorship of Dr L.P. Shihare of the National Gallery of Modern Art. Among the most recognised art works in the world Rodin's *The Thinker* came to India in 1983. This was the first time internationally-acclaimed works were brought to India.



BANDEEP SINGH

4 Turning Point NGMA Opens in Mumbai

"The National Gallery of Modern Art (NGMA) could not have had a more appropriate exhibition to open its new branch in Mumbai last fortnight in the magnificent and recently restored Cowasji Jehangir Public Hall—it took 12 years and Rs 3.5 crore," noted INDIA TODAY in January 1997. It took India 42 years to add another NGMA to the culturescape of the country. The gallery's presence in Mumbai and the one that is scheduled to open in Bangalore are major landmarks in the Indian art world.